



Name: Cohort/Batch: Date: Score:

SERVICENOW PRACTICE SHEET - 10 CONCEPTUAL Q&A

10 conceptual Q&A Enterprise

TOTAL: 10 QUESTIONS

Q1 What is ServiceNow and what problem in Enterprise does it solve?

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Q6 How does ServiceNow handle reliability and high availability?

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Q2 What are the core components or concepts in ServiceNow?

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Q7 What observability does ServiceNow provide out of the box?

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Q3 How does ServiceNow compare to its main alternatives?

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Q8 What are common performance bottlenecks in ServiceNow?

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Q4 How do you get started with ServiceNow for a new project?

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Q9 What security best practices apply when running ServiceNow?

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Q5 What configuration options most affect ServiceNow's behavior in production?

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Q10 What mistakes do teams commonly make when adopting ServiceNow?

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ANSWER KEY & EXPLANATORY SOLUTIONS

Comprehensive verified answers, best-practice configs, security controls & reference

VERIFIED SOLUTIONS

A1 ServiceNow is a tool or platform that

Mitigation

ServiceNow is a tool or platform that automates or simplifies a specific concern in the Enterprise domain, reducing manual effort and operational complexity for engineering teams.

A6 ServiceNow provides HA through leader election, replication, or stateless

ServiceNow provides HA through leader election, replication, or stateless horizontal scaling. Deploy at least two instances across availability zones and configure health checks for automatic failover.

A2 ServiceNow has key building blocks that work

Primitives

ServiceNow has key building blocks that work together: a configuration layer defines intent, a runtime layer enforces it, and an API or CLI layer allows operators to manage and observe the system.

A7 ServiceNow exposes metrics (Prometheus endpoint or built-in dashboard)

ServiceNow exposes metrics (Prometheus endpoint or built-in dashboard), structured logs, and optionally distributed traces. Define SLOs on the key metrics and alert before users are affected.

A3 ServiceNow trades off simplicity against feature richness

Hardening

ServiceNow trades off simplicity against feature richness differently than its alternatives. Choose ServiceNow when its specific strengths performance, ecosystem, or ease of use align with your team's primary constraints.

A8 Performance bottlenecks typically stem from misconfigured connection pools

Performance bottlenecks typically stem from misconfigured connection pools, large payload sizes, insufficient worker threads, or missing caches. Profile with built-in diagnostics before optimizing.

A4 Install ServiceNow via its package manager or binary release

Gotchas

Install ServiceNow via its package manager or binary release. Follow the quickstart to initialize a project, configure the minimal required settings, and run the default command to verify the setup works end-to-end.

A9 Run ServiceNow with the principle of least privilege

Assessment

Run ServiceNow with the principle of least privilege, enable TLS for all communication, use a secrets manager for credentials, and keep the software patched to the latest stable release.

A5 Production-critical settings typically include concurrency limits, timeout values, retry policies, resource limits, and logging levels

Configuration

Production-critical settings typically include concurrency limits, timeout values, retry policies, resource limits, and logging levels. Review the official production hardening guide before deploying.

A10 Common pitfalls include skipping the documentation and learning the API by trial and error

Common pitfalls include skipping the documentation and learning the API by trial and error, using default configurations in production, lacking a runbook for operational issues, and not testing failover scenarios.